

AI Adoption Training

Workshop #3: AI for Operational Excellence

Spring 2026



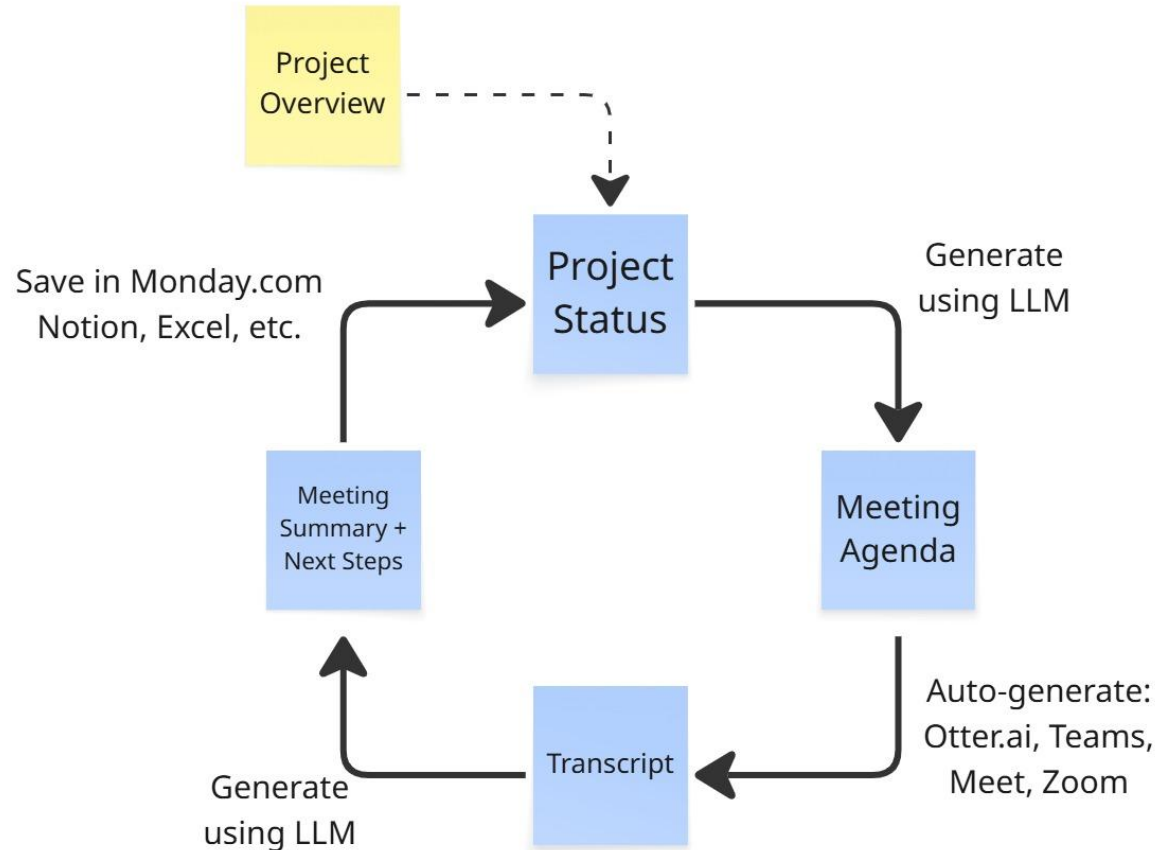
Today's Agenda

1. **Intro** (5 mins)
2. **Project Management Workflows** (15 mins)
3. **Data and Quantitative Analysis (Excel)** (20 mins)
4. **Creating Presentations (Powerpoint)** (10 minutes)
5. **Productivity Techniques** (10 mins)
6. **Wrap Up** (5 mins)

Materials are available at: https://github.com/mullinsean/ai_training_2026

AI for Project Management

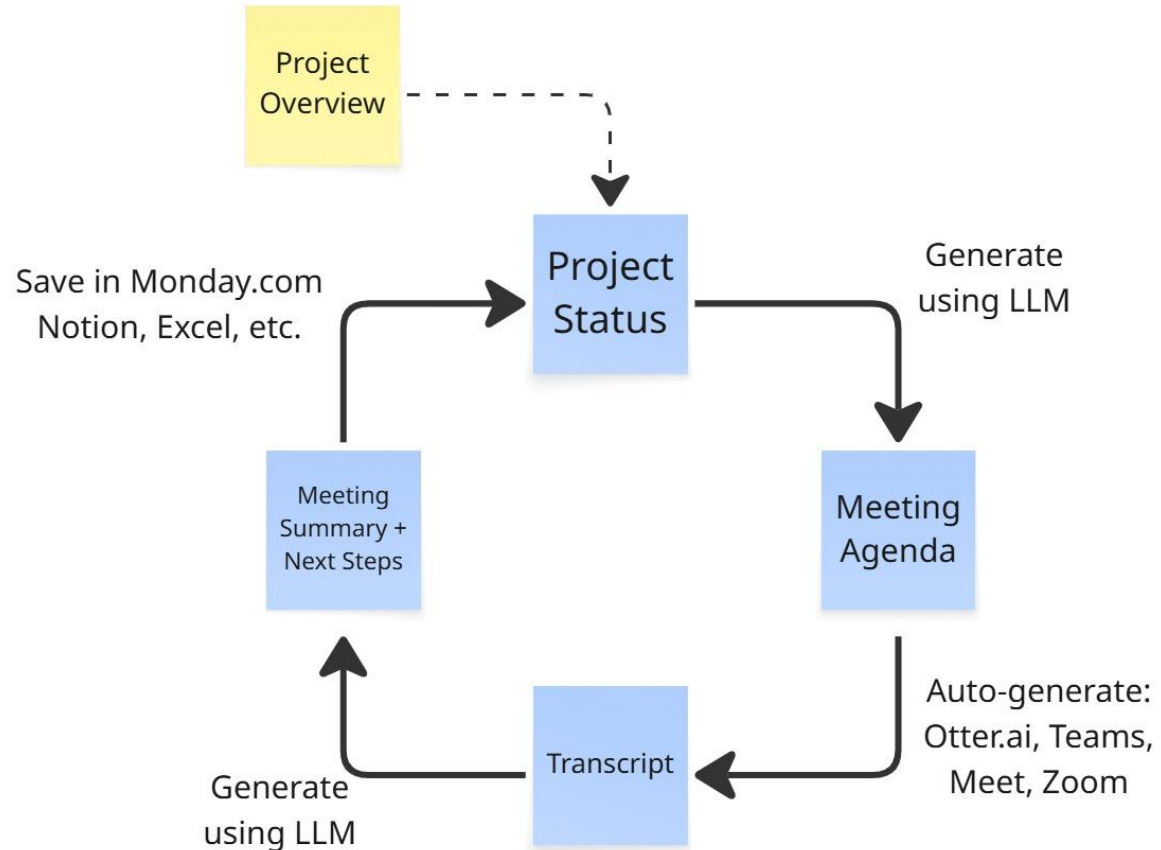
Simplified project management cycle



- LLMs can streamline project management cycles and help keep teams organized, prioritized and informed.
 - However, this use is still early and workflows and UX are still being worked out
- Legacy project management tools are rapidly evolving to catch up to LLMs, but many still require manual connection (ie: copy & paste) to use LLMs.
- Important to think through how your existing tools (eg: monday.com, Excel, etc.) can be enhanced with selective LLM use.
- We will go through some tools (Claude/ChatGPT projects, MCP connectors, data stores) that make this easier.

AI for Project Management

Simplified project management cycle



Best Practices for Project Management:

1. Produce a solid, clear project overview at the beginning of a project; ensure it stays up to date. *Always* add to context window.
2. Attach agendas and project status updates to calendar invites.
3. Designate one person (meeting owner or project lead) to generate transcript and meeting summary.
4. Save transcripts and summaries in a central location. Chat session links, too!
5. Ideally, standardize on one project management tool for the entire organization.
6. Review before sending out agendas and next steps!

AI for Project Management

Sample prompts for the project management cycle



Prompt: Summarize Meeting

```
You are summarizing a project meeting. Use the project state document for context.
```

```
<project_state>
[Paste project state document]
</project_state>
```

```
<meeting_transcript>
[Paste transcript]
</meeting_transcript>
```

Create:

1. Executive summary (3-4 sentences)
2. Key decisions made
3. Action items (format: Task | Owner | Deadline | Status)
4. Important discussion points
5. Risks or blockers raised
6. Items for next meeting

```
Format professionally for circulation to team.
```

Prompt: Meeting Agenda

```
Using the project state document, generate an agenda for our weekly check-in meeting on [date].
```

Include:

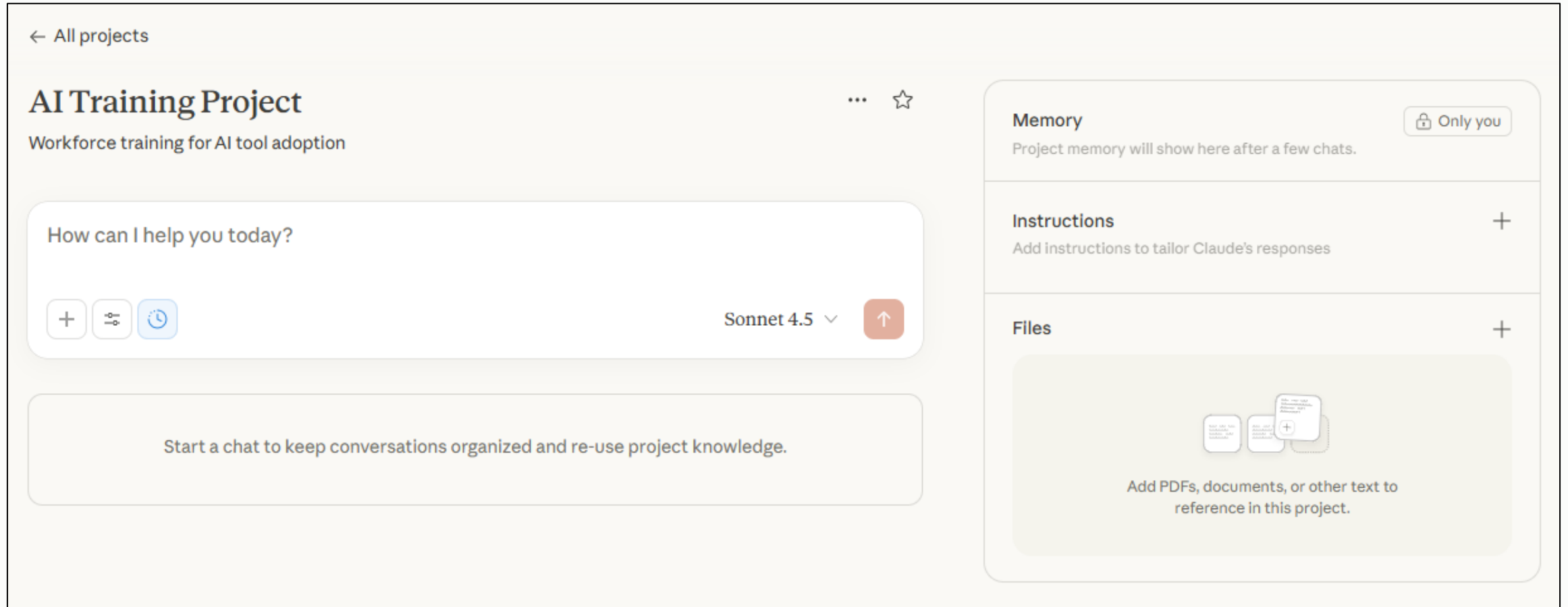
- Review of action items from last meeting (attached)
- Key decisions needed this week
- Updates on [specific milestone]
- Time allocation for each item (60 min total)

```
Format as a structured agenda with objectives for each section.
```

Example Project Overview: "[Beyond Zero](#)"

AI for Project Management

Using the “Project” feature in Claude or ChatGPT



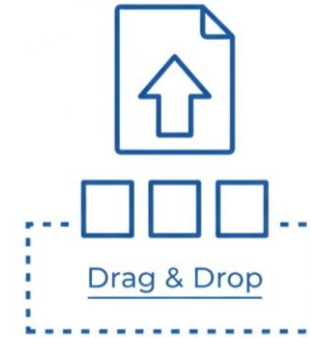
Connecting to Data Sources

How LLMs Can Access Your Information

- LLMs need data to provide context.
- There are a number of ways to link data to chat sessions beyond just uploading each time.
- Most LLMs can natively handle PDFs, word, spreadsheet, images.
- Remember: The context window is still your biggest constraint; provide data sparingly.

Method 1: Direct Uploads

- Drag & drop files into chat



Method 2: Project Files

- Persistent access across all project conversations
- Limit on aggregate size of files per project



Method 3: Shared Drive Integration

- Google Drive, Dropbox, OneDrive, SharePoint
- Enable in settings → search across all files



Shared Drive Integration

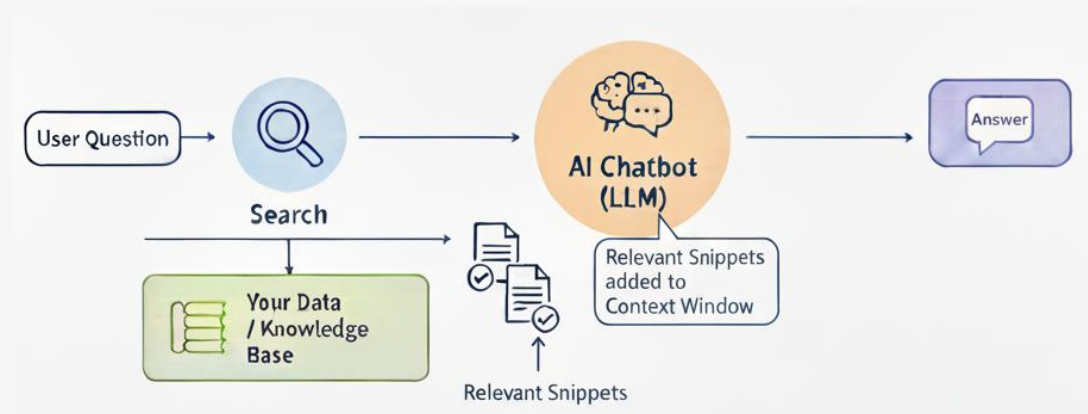
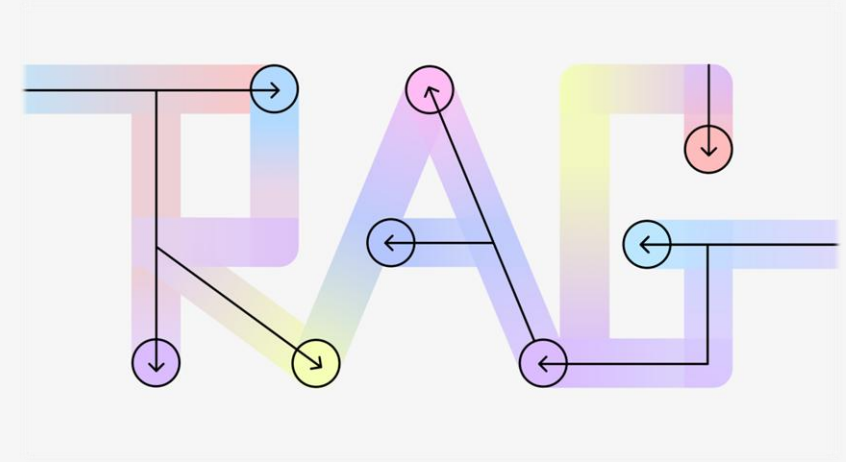
Method 4: Model Context Protocol (MCP):

- Connect AI to external tools & databases
- Examples: monday.com, Slack, GitHub, custom databases

Connecting to Data Sources

But *how* LLMs use your data differs by method

- Large data stores (eg: Google Drive) can often return too many files, which will overwhelm the context window.
- Instead, LLM connectors employ a technique called Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG) to supply the LLM with data.
- LLMs search these data sources for documents that are relevant to the question being asked.
 - “Chunks” of documents are returned and passed to the LLM for inclusion in the context window.
- This is not as effective as passing entire documents to context window, but is a necessary trade off for large data stores.



Data and Quantitative Analysis

LLMs can be powerful tools for investigating data

- Claude, ChatGPT and Gemini are all able to natively handle Excel spreadsheets
- Under the hood, the LLMs are writing code and calling tools to perform requested data analysis
- LLMs can also clean datasets!
- Uploading datasets in .csv format (comma-separated values) often makes it easier for the LLM
 - Include data dictionaries to provide context

Example:

Explore and analyse changes in fuel consumption ratings for vehicles sold in Canada over the past ten years.

Use the following open data set:

- [Fuel Consumption Ratings \(NRCan\)](#)

Data and Quantitative Analysis

Fuel consumption ratings example

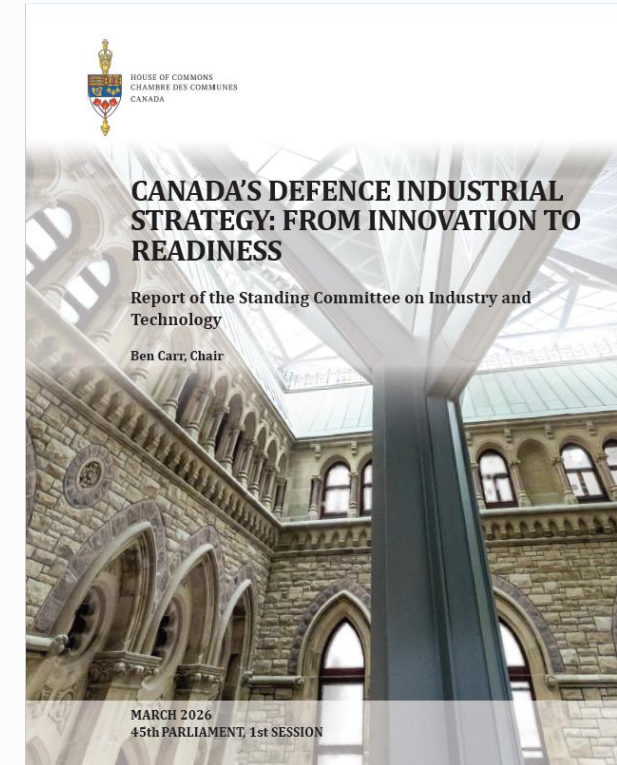
Process Step	Activity	Example
1. Explore Data Set	Generate table of average fuel efficiency by manufacturer	Claude: chat , output (.md) ChatGPT: chat , output (.xlsx)
2. Build a Model in Excel	Build model that calculates value of fuel efficiency savings between two vehicles	Claude: chat , output (.xlsx) ChatGPT: chat , output (.xlsx) Gemini: output (.xlsx)
3. Investigate Trends and Answer Detailed Questions	- What vehicles have shown biggest increase in fuel efficiency over 2014-2025? - What was the average increase in fuel economy from introducing a hybrid model?	Transcript: chat Output: xlsx
4. Generating Insights from Data	Ask model to generate insights.	Transcript: chat Output: md

Creating Slide Decks / Presentations

LLMs can help build slide decks

- LLMs are not great at building visually stunning presentations (at least not yet), but they can be very helpful in building the “scaffolding” for a good slide deck.
- Break the job down into steps:
 1. Create an outline first
 2. Populate the outline with content
 3. Generate the slide deck
 4. Edit, tweak, add visual elements
- **Example:** *Create a presentation that provides a factual, non-partisan overview of the following report for a public audience interested in Canadian public policy.*

Example:



([link](#))

Creating Slide Decks / Presentations

Industry Committee report example

Process Step	Activity	Example
1. Generate Outline	Generate first a rough outline and then a more detailed outline from the original report	Transcript: chat Output: outline (.md)
2. Generate the Presentation	Generate a draft presentation using the outline	Claude: chat , output (.pptx) ChatGPT: chat , output (.pptx) Gemini: chat , output

Image Generation Tools

Image generation tools passed a quality threshold in 2025...

- AI image tools have moved from novelty generators to practical visual-production assistants
 - In particular, ChatGPT Images 2.0 and Gemini Image 3.1
- Use plain-language prompts to create, edit, localize, and reformat images inside Gemini or ChatGPT
- Stronger at text, diagrams, infographics, icons, mockups, visual explanations, and multi-step edits
- Best for rapid prototyping and “good enough” design work; still requires iteration, fact-checking, and human review

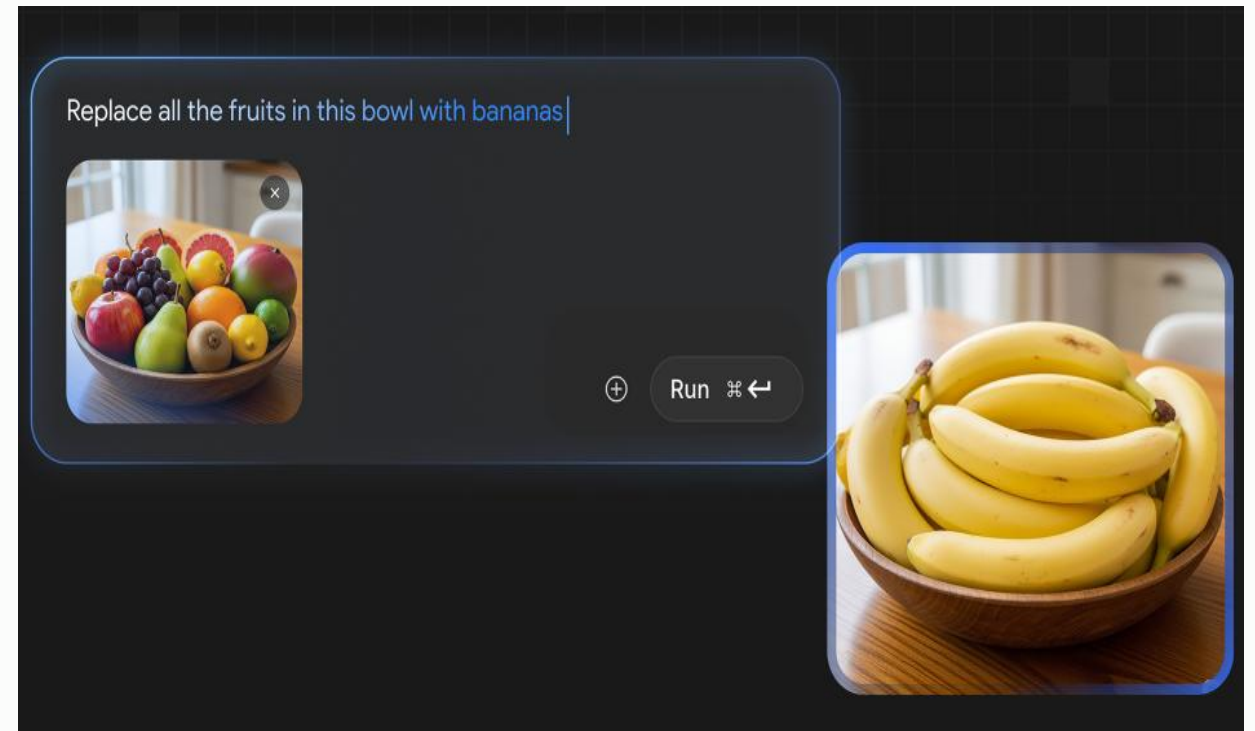
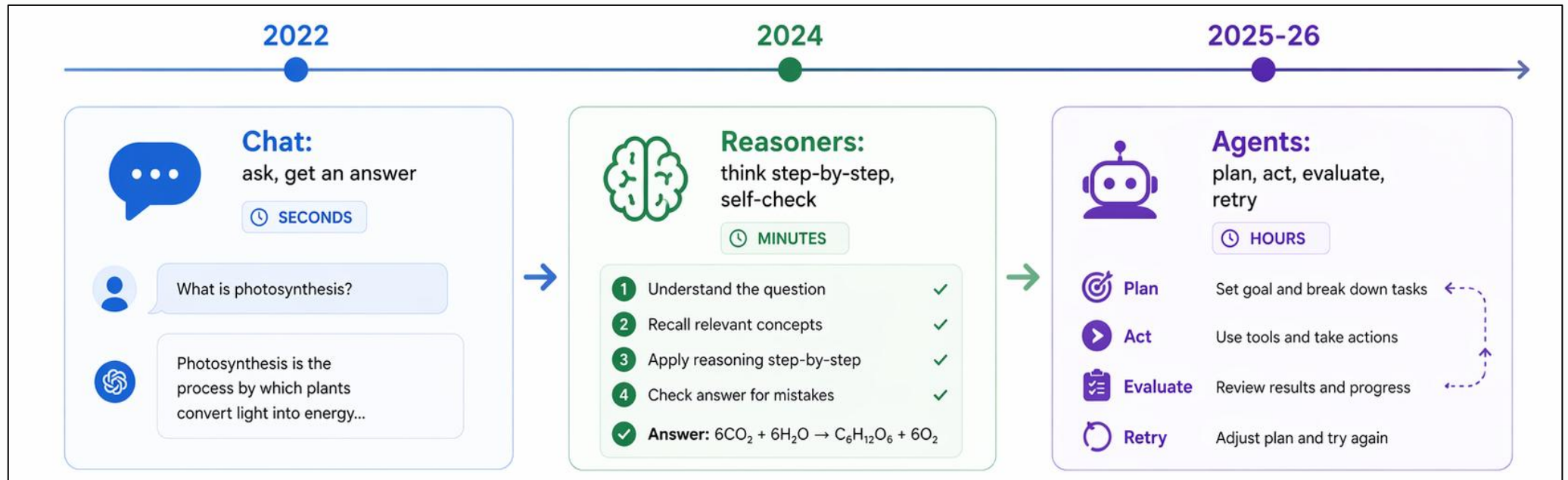


Image Generation Tools

Example: ChatGPT Image 2.0



Prompt:

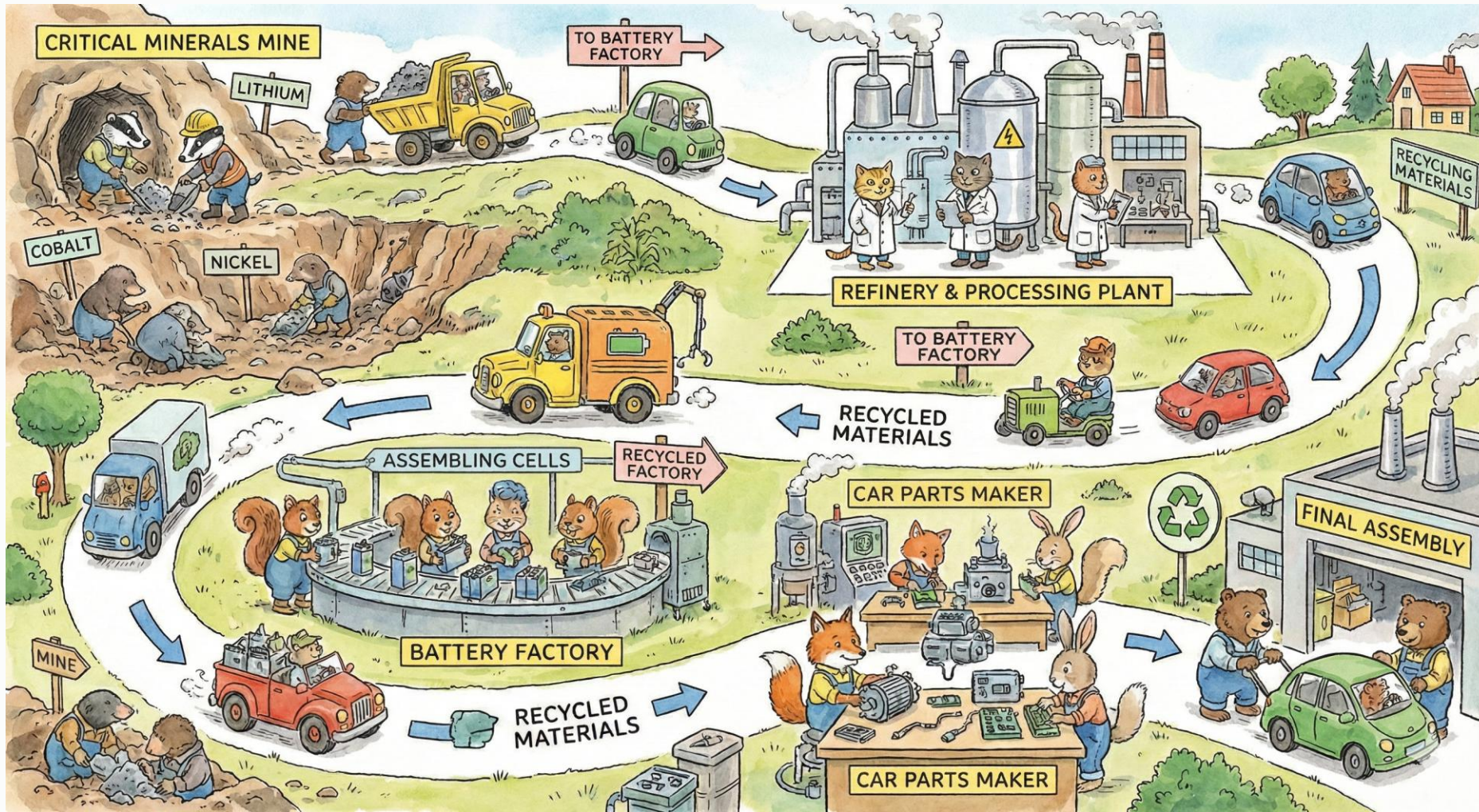
****Visual concept:****

A three-step timeline, left to right:

- ****2022**** — ***Chat:*** ask, get an answer (seconds)
- ****2024**** — ***Reasoners:*** think step-by-step, self-check (minutes)
- ****2025-26**** — ***Agents:*** plan, act, evaluate, retry (hours)

Image Generation Tools

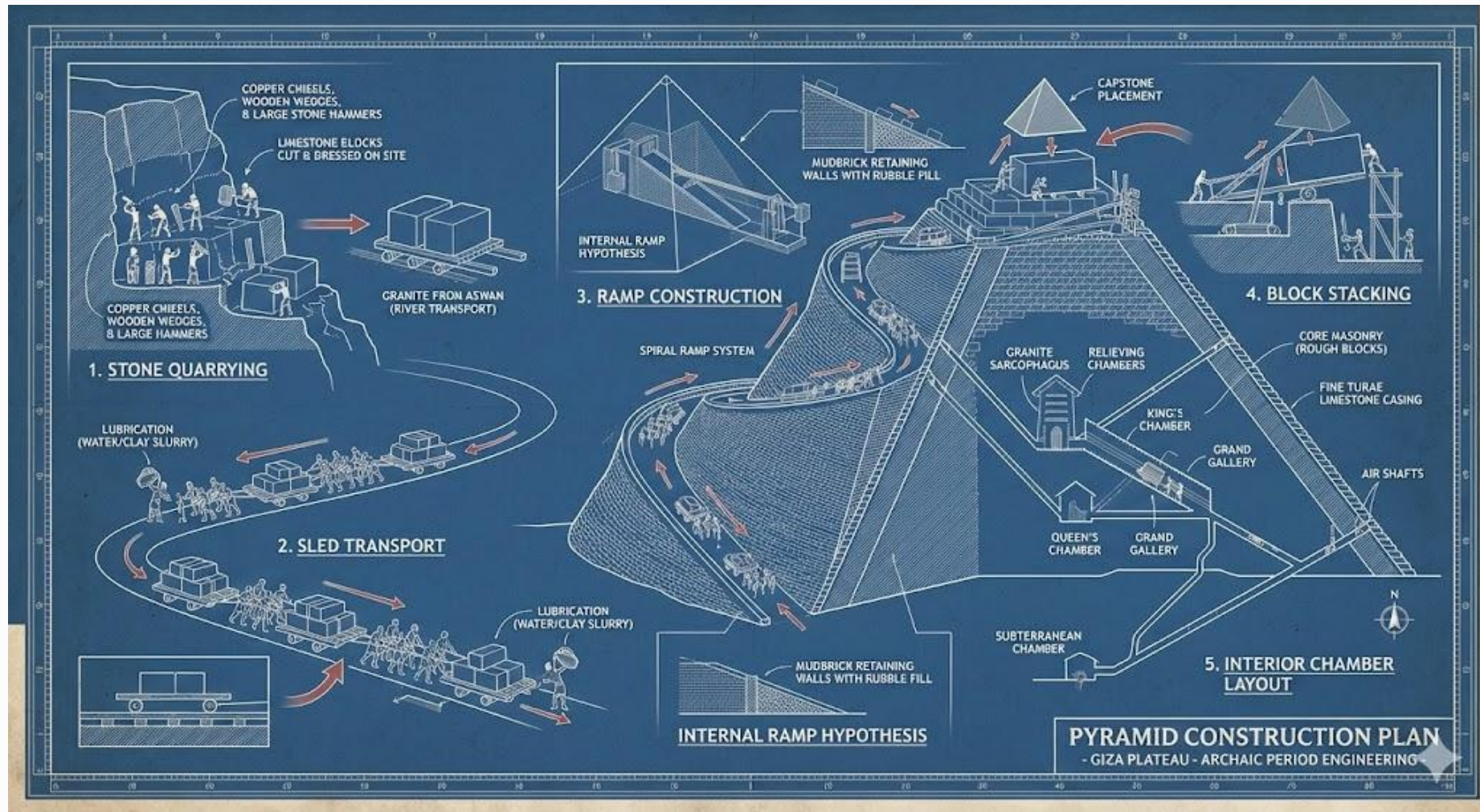
Example: Gemini Image 3.0



Google's Gemini 3.0 "Nano Banana" asked to visualize the EV supply chain in the style of a Richard Scarry cartoon...

Image Generation Tools

Example: Gemini Image 3.0



Prompt:

Create a visual "blueprint style" diagram explaining how the Egyptians built pyramid.

Productivity Techniques

Scheduling research or analysis in ChatGPT

- ChatGPT allows you to schedule LLM queries to run daily, weekly, or at custom intervals.
 - Set up by simply asking ChatGPT (eg: "Create a new weekly query that does X")
 - Access existing queries via Settings → Schedules
- Can be a very useful tool for staying on top of particular topics and automating routine tasks

Edit schedule

Name

Create weekly Canadian macro brief

Instructions

Tell me what happened in the Canadian economy over the past seven days. Focus on key macro developments, major announcements and important data releases from agencies like Statistics Canada, the Bank of Canada, CMHC and similar bodies. Then write a concise one-page weekly macro brief I can read quickly on Monday morning.

When

Weekly Monday 9:00 AM

Pause Delete Cancel Save

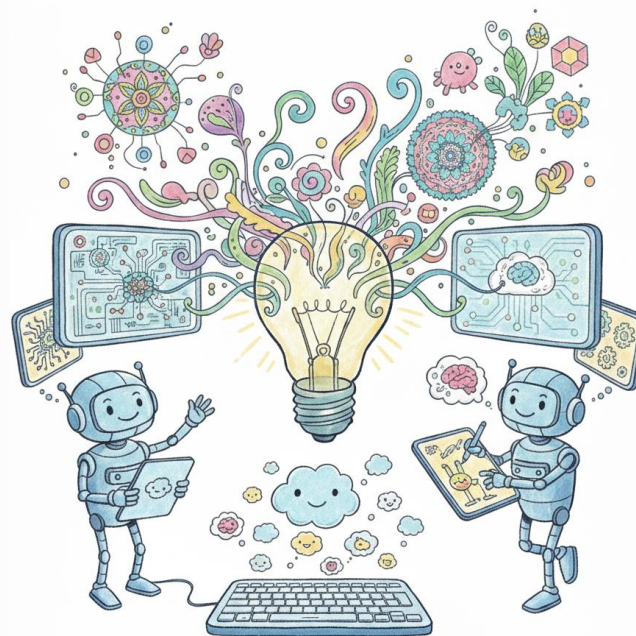
([example](#))

Productivity Techniques

Enhancing creativity via brainstorming and prototyping

Brainstorming

- LLMs can be very helpful with brainstorming
- Provide context via project overview, background research materials
- Use voice dictation to free you from typing into blank screen
- Ask LLM to keep track of ideas as you add them via message dumps
- Periodically summarize and organize ideas
- Generate document at end of session



Prototyping

- LLMs significantly reduce cost of creating prototypes: draft versions of articles, websites, images, etc.
- Instead of carefully creating one version of a document, consider generating multiple versions earlier in the process
- Eg: Write five versions of this article for The Economist, each with different angles or core theses.
- Choose which one is best or even synthesize elements from different versions.

Thank You!



Sean Mullin

sean.mullin@gmail.com

www.seanmullin.com